UK · STATUTORY SICK PAY

Sick pay in the UK now starts on day one

What changed on 6 April 2026, in three numbers.

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WHEN IT STARTS

Day 1

SSP is paid from the first full day off sick

The three unpaid waiting days were removed.

HOW MUCH

£123.25

a week, or 80% of normal weekly earnings if lower

Earn £100 a week? 80% is **£80**, lower than £123.25, so SSP is £80 a week.

WHO IT REACHES

1.3m

low-paid employees got no SSP before the change, per Acas

The lower earnings limit is gone, so part-time and lower-paid staff now qualify.

YOUR TURN

Did you know SSP now starts on day one?

Yes or no in the comments.

Sources: GOV.UK, "Statutory Sick Pay"; Acas, "Statutory sick pay changes 2026". General information, not legal advice.